

What is phishing?

Phishing is when attackers pretend to be someone you trust to steal information or access to your account.

Common examples

- Fake IT messages asking you to verify your password
- Texts about financial aid, account problems, or package deliveries
- QR codes that send you to a fake login page

Attacker goal

Steal passwords, gain account access, deliver malware, or trick you into sending personal or financial information.

If you clicked, act fast

- 1 Disconnect**
Disconnect from Wi-Fi or unplug the network cable.
- 2 Report**
Report it to Hocking College IT right away.
- 3 Change passwords**
Update your password and any reused passwords.
- 4 Watch accounts**
Monitor email, MFA prompts, and other accounts for unusual activity.

Remember: Stop. Check. Report.

Protect your account. Protect Hocking.
Contact Hocking College IT Support

Helpdesk@hocking.edu | 740-753-6113

Don't Take the Bait!



Pause. Verify. Protect.

Simple steps to avoid phishing at Hocking College.

Think Before You Click

Hocking Phishing Awareness Program

Phishing prevention DOs

- ✓ Verify the sender and check the full email address.
- ✓ Hover over links before clicking to inspect where they really go.
- ✓ Use strong, unique passwords for school and personal accounts.
- ✓ Enable multi-factor authentication whenever it is available.
- ✓ Report suspicious emails, texts, or QR codes to IT.

Quick tip

Real Hocking College messages should not pressure you to send passwords or approve MFA prompts you did not request.

Common signs of phishing

- ⚠ Urgent language that tries to rush you
- ⚠ Unexpected attachments or login requests
- ⚠ Suspicious links or QR codes
- ⚠ Misspelled names, email addresses, or domains
- ⚠ Requests for personal, financial, or account information
- ⚠ Generic greetings such as "Dear Student" or "From HR"

Pause before you click

Taking a few seconds to verify a message can prevent account compromise and protect campus data.

Phishing prevention DON'Ts

- ✗ Do not email or text passwords or verification codes.
- ✗ Do not click links from unknown senders.
- ✗ Do not open attachments you were not expecting.
- ✗ Do not reuse the same password across accounts.
- ✗ Do not trust an urgent request until you verify it another way.

Watch for pressure tactics

Phishing often uses fear, curiosity, or authority to push quick decisions. Slow down and verify first.